Photo magnet press: what it costs in India

Updated 29 October 2026. Prices researched 28–29 October 2026 from sellers' own pages, IndiaMART, TradeIndia, Moglix and institute rate cards. All prices are before GST (18 %) and transport. Treat every figure as ±30 % (±40 % for the light build, which is not designed yet) and get two or three written quotes. Andhra Pradesh and Delhi NCR are listed first.

Read this first: three ways to get a press

- **Market:** a ready-made machine from a seller. One size per machine. These are **market prices**.
- **Light build:** a press like the market one, only slightly heavier. Aluminium plates, two chrome columns, a simple lever, and steel dies that are not hardened, one size at a time. **Not designed yet:** this column is an estimate of our build cost.
- **Heavy MagPress:** the MagPress M4 as drawn (Rev E). Steel frame for 16 kN, hardened tool-steel kits, eight sizes on one frame. These are our **build costs**. "All eight kits ₹1.6–3.2 lakh" is 8 × ₹20,000–40,000 to have every kit made; it is not a market price.
- **Consumables:** start with bought pre-cut tin, film and back plus your own printed photo (Phase 1); move to your own raw materials later (Phase 2). Section 3.

Status

Heavy MagPress: frame, drive and fits verified; the square size kits failed the forming check and are on hold until your findings from taking apart a bought magnet are in. Light build: not designed; it would need the same forming checks before anything is made. Market machines: proven, available now.

1. Side by side

	Market (ready-made)	Light build: slightly heavier than market estimate	Heavy MagPress (as drawn)
What it is	A seller's machine and its dies, one size	Aluminium plates and lever, two Ø20 chrome columns, unhardened steel dies on coil springs, sized for the real forming load (about 6–8 kN)	Steel frame and toggle for 16 kN, hardened D2 kits cut by wire EDM, eight sizes on one universal die
Weight, one size	about 10–15 kg (sellers' figures)	about 15–20 kg	about 48 kg
Weight, all eight sizes	8 machines	about 15–20 kg + about 2–3 kg per extra die set	about 70 kg (45 kg press + 25 kg of kits; one kit fitted at a time)
Machine without dies	—	₹14,000 – 28,000	₹65,000 – 1,05,000
One size die set	included	₹6,000 – 14,000	₹20,000 – 40,000
Machine with one size	**₹10,000 – 46,000**	**₹20,000 – 42,000**	**₹0.85 – 1.45 lakh**
Each extra size	another machine, ₹10,000 – 46,000	₹6,000 – 14,000	₹20,000 – 40,000
All eight sizes	8 machines (Indian prices not found for every size)	₹62,000 – 1,40,000	₹2.25 – 4.25 lakh
Die life	not stated by sellers	tens of thousands of magnets (chrome or nitrided steel; re-polish, then remake)	500,000 strokes and more (hardened D2)
Status	Proven; buy now	Needs a design and the forming checks first	Frame verified; square kits on hold

Market prices: ₹10,000 for a 50 × 50 plastic-body press with cutter and 100 sets; ₹16,500–30,000 for a metal-body 50 × 50; about ₹46,000 for 80 × 53 with a cutter (Copier Bazar, IndiaMART). A one-off light build costs about the same as buying, because the factory makes thousands of machines. It pays only if you want sizes the market does not sell, several sizes on one frame, or you have cheap access to machining.

Cost per magnet: the same on any press whose dies fit the material

Phase	What you buy	Per magnet
Phase 1, to start: bought pre-cut tin, film and back, your own printed photo	Material sets sold for the machine size (sellers usually include the magnet sheet; check), plus inkjet paper and ink	≈ ₹27 – 30
Phase 2, later: your own raw materials	Tinplate sheet, PET film roll, card or board, magnet sheet, paper; cut to size yourself	≈ ₹10 – 15
Saving from Phase 2	**Worth switching once you sell steadily; needs a hand guillotine, a corner cutter and a paper cutter**	**≈ ₹12 – 20**

2. How the press and die estimates are made

Light build, machine without dies estimate

Item	Cost
6061 aluminium plate and bar, about 10 kg bought, ₹350–450/kg	₹3,500 – 4,500
Two Ø20 hard-chrome columns, cut and ground	₹500 – 1,000
Pivot pins and small steel parts	₹500 – 1,000
CNC machining, about 15–20 h at a private shop (₹250–450/h)	₹4,000 – 9,000
Anodising and finishing	₹1,000 – 2,000
Bought parts: return springs, die-cup springs, bushings, fasteners, grip	₹3,000 – 6,000
Fitting and contingency	₹1,500 – 4,500
Total	**₹14,000 – 28,000**

Heavy MagPress, machine without a kit

Item	Cost
Frame and drive: about 40 machine hours, profile cutting, about 85 kg of steel, aluminium and bronze, hardened pins, black oxide, anodise, powder coat	₹40,000 – 60,000
Universal die: about 17 machine hours (die body, shank, upper carrier, two lower carriers, two station bases), material, black oxide	₹12,000 – 20,000
Bought parts: ISO die springs, bushings, fasteners, pins, plungers, detent pin, small parts	₹12,000 – 25,000
Total (about ₹1.7 lakh with a kit if every part is made at institute tool-room rates)	**₹65,000 – 1,05,000**

One size: die set (light) against kit (heavy)

Step	Light die set estimate	Light	Heavy kit (as drawn)	Heavy
Steel	EN24 / C45, about 3 kg, with cutting	₹500 – 1,000	D2 tool steel, about 8 kg at ₹260–290/kg	₹2,100 – 2,300
CNC machining	About 6–8 h, private shop	₹1,500 – 3,600	About 5 h before hardening, private shop to tool room	₹1,300 – 7,000
Hardening	None	—	Vacuum hardening, double temper, 58–60 HRC	₹2,000 – 5,000
Wire EDM	Sharp-cornered openings in soft steel, fewer passes	₹2,500 – 5,000	After hardening, main + 2 skim cuts, about 60,000 mm²	₹7,200 – 14,400
Finishing	Polish the forming edges; hard chrome or nitride	₹1,500 – 3,500	Grinding, edge radii, lapping, polishing (about 6 h)	₹2,500 – 8,000
Small parts	Coil springs, pins	₹500 – 1,000	Dowel pins, four M3 ball plungers, plug stud	₹1,000 – 2,500
Total	**Rounded**	**₹6,000 – 14,000**	**Rounded up for set-up and minimum charges**	**₹20,000 – 40,000**

Why the heavy kit costs more: hardened tool steel cut to 0.01 mm by wire EDM after hardening, built for 500,000+ strokes. Ways to bring it down: make only the sizes you sell, have several kits made together (one hardening batch and EDM set-up), turn round kits on a lathe, and use private shops rather than institute tool rooms.

3. Consumables per magnet (63.5 × 63.5)

Phase 1: start with pre-cut tin, film and back; print your own photo

Item	Where	Per magnet
Pre-cut material set: tin, film, back (usually with the magnet sheet)	Sold with the machines and separately: Copier Bazar (+91 88899 15080), IndiaMART sellers. Buy sets made for your machine's size	₹25 – 27
Your own photo	Inkjet printer, 90–120 g/m² matte paper (≈ ₹1) and ink (≈ ₹1–2)	₹2 – 3
Total, Phase 1		**≈ ₹27 – 30**

Phase 2: your own raw materials, later

Item	Spec	Where	Per magnet
Tin blank	0.20 mm soft (T2) electrolytic tinplate, cut to the blank size, corners clipped (a 65 × 90 blank weighs about 11 g)	Optimum Steels, New Delhi, ETP sheet ₹72 per kg; Diamond Tin & Metal, Kolkata, 0.20 mm ₹97 per kg. Cut with a hand guillotine and a corner cutter, or have a ₹5,000–15,000 blanking die made per size	≈ ₹1
Photo	90–120 g/m² inkjet matte paper	Any stationer	≈ ₹2 – 3
Film	0.075 mm PET (Mylar)	Polyester film rolls ₹100–180 per kg; Sudershan Paper Mart, Delhi	< ₹1
Back	Card or board cut to size (as in bought sets), or laser-cut ABS / MDF	Paper merchants (Chawri Bazar, Delhi, is the main paper market); laser cutters	₹2 – 6
Magnet sheet	Self-adhesive flexible magnet, 0.5 mm, A4	IndiaMART sellers, ₹15–64 per A4 sheet (self-adhesive ₹64 in Greater Noida)	₹4 – 7
Total, Phase 2		**Measure a bought set first so your blanks match your dies**	**≈ ₹10 – 15**

4. Where to get each part

This list is for the heavy MagPress as drawn. The light build buys a smaller set: aluminium plate and bar instead of the steel plate and C45/EN19, two chrome columns, light coil springs under the die cups instead of ISO 10243 die springs, unhardened steel dies, and fewer fasteners. The same shops and markets supply both.

Machining

Work	Andhra Pradesh	Delhi NCR	Best option / price
Size-kit parts: CNC rough, wire EDM after hardening, grinding, CMM check	**MSME Technology Centre, Visakhapatnam**, Plot 6, Industrial Corridor, Pudi, Atchutapuram 531011; +91 95153 97533, 08924-282600; info@msmetcvizag.org. CNC mills and lathes, wire-cut and die-sink EDM, grinders, CMM. No vacuum furnace listed: send kit parts out for hardening	NSIC Technical Services Centre, Okhla (99799 33266, 011-26826801 ext. 228); private tool rooms in Okhla, Mayapuri, Wazirpur, Faridabad	**CITD Hyderabad** (MSME Tool Room, Balanagar), the nearest full tool room to AP: wire cut, EDM, VMC, CNC lathes, grinding. Call or visit
Frame, drive, universal die (C45, S355, 42CrMo4)	MSME TC Visakhapatnam; CNC shops in the Vijayawada and Visakhapatnam Autonagars	CNC job shops in Okhla, Mayapuri, Naraina, Faridabad	Any shop with a 3-axis VMC and a CNC lathe
Laser or plasma cut blanks (base plate, lever); laser-cut backs	Local fabricators	Faridabad laser job work, ₹25–30 per minute for steel	Acrylic: ₹50–245 per sq ft, or ₹15–90 per running foot

Rates to check quotes against: VMC ₹250–450/h at small private shops, ₹1,030–1,400/h at institute tool rooms (CSIR-CMERI). CNC lathe ₹400/h (IIT Kanpur, industry) to ₹1,150/h (CMERI). Wire EDM ₹0.12–0.24 per mm² of cut face (≈ ₹77–155 per sq inch) at private shops; ₹480–580/h at IIT Madras, ₹900/h at IIT Kanpur, ₹1,240/h at CMERI.

Heat treatment and finishing

Process	Parts	Andhra Pradesh	Delhi NCR	Price
Vacuum hardening 58–60 HRC, double temper	Size-kit parts (D2), about 6 kg per kit	Hyderabad tool rooms and heat treaters (Balanagar, Jeedimetla)	**voestalpine High Performance Metals India**, C-19, Site C, UPSIDC Surajpur, Greater Noida 201306; 85888 91063	₹2,000 – 5,000 per batch
Through-hardening and grinding	Pins A, B, O (EN31), station pilot, die holder (EN19)	Local heat treaters	Local heat treaters; Maxwell Tools, Rajpura (vacuum)	₹1,000 – 2,000
Black oxide	Frame and drive steel parts	Local platers	Local platers	₹1,000 – 2,000
Hard anodise	Die table (6061); mask the pilot and dowel holes	Hyderabad / Chennai platers	Delhi listing ₹3 per sq inch	₹500 – 800
Hard chrome	Columns, only if not bought as chrome bar	—	Greater Noida listing ₹4 per sq inch	₹500 – 800
Powder coat	Base plate	Local	Local	₹500 – 1,000

Materials and bought parts

Item	Spec and quantity	Andhra Pradesh	Delhi NCR	Best option / price
Kit tool steel	D2 (1.2379, "HCHCr"), about 8 kg bought per kit. A2 is rarely stocked in India; D2 is the one to order	Through the tool room	Loha Mandi, Naraina (e.g. Goel Steel Emporium); voestalpine Greater Noida (Böhler K110 = D2)	₹260–290 per kg generic; branded more
Carbon and alloy steel	C45 (≈ EN8/EN9) and 42CrMo4 (≈ EN19) bar and plate, about 45 kg	Stockists in Vijayawada / Visakhapatnam	Loha Mandi, Naraina	₹65–90 per kg
Base plate steel	S355 (≈ IS 2062 E350), 20 mm, 480 × 490, about 37 kg	RINL / SAIL stockists	Naraina	₹51–60 per kg + cutting
Columns	Ø25 × 210 mm, 2 off: 100Cr6 hardened, ground, hard-chromed, or induction-hardened chrome bar ground to Ø25 h6	—	Indian Hydraulic Products, Delhi: IH chrome bar ₹150 per kg (≈ ₹600 per metre at Ø25)	₹600–1,200 for both. Hydraulic rod is usually f7: ask for h6
Die table	6061-T6 plate, 12 mm, 340 × 150	Aluminium stockists	Aluminium stockists	₹350–450 per kg (≈ ₹700)
Bronze	CuSn8 / phosphor bronze rod, pivot spacers	Local	Local	₹400–1,000 per kg
Die springs	ISO 10243: 8 × Ø10 × 32 green, 8 × Ø12.5 × 44 red	Order online	Pi-Tech Services, New Delhi; Standard Ring Pvt Ltd, Karnal Road	Prosoc and Maxima (Bengaluru), FIBRO India (Pune): ₹100–300 each, **₹2,000–5,000** for 16
PTFE-composite bushes (DU type)	16×18×15 (2), 16×18×20 (1), 12×14×20 (2), 12×14×6 (4)	Bearing shops	Shraddhanand Marg / G.B. Road bearing stores (e.g. RM Overseas, Nitin Machinery Stores)	₹15–150 each; ≈ ₹1,000
Bronze flanged bushes	Self-lubricating, 25 × 32 × 33, 2 off	Bearing shops	Same	₹300–600 each

Item	Spec and quantity	Andhra Pradesh	Delhi NCR	Best option / price
Socket screws, nuts, set screws	Grade 12.9 (Unbrako or TVS), full list in the parts list	Local hardware	**Bazar Sirkiwalan, Chandni Chowk** (e.g. Reliance Fasteners, Panchsheel Fasteners); Moglix online	₹1,500–3,000
Shoulder screws ISO 7379	Ø6 × 10 (4), Ø6 × 12 (8)	Online	Unbrako dealers	₹80–200 each
Dowel pins, hardened m6	Frame and universal die about 13; per kit 6	Online	Unbrako dealers	₹500–1,000
Ball plungers	M3 × 4 per kit; M6 × 1	Online	MISUMI India (from ₹953); IndiaMART	₹1,000–4,000
Quick-release detent pin	Ø6, 64 usable, ring handle	Online	Jergens India (₹3,000) or generic stainless (₹200)	₹200–3,000
Return springs	Music wire Ø3.5, OD 31.5, free length 128, 2 off (made to order)	Local spring maker	Spring makers in Wazirpur / Karnal Road	₹300–800 for two
Nord-Lock washers	M8 (4), M16 (2)	Online	Online	₹1,500–3,000; or Loctite 243 with plain hardened washers
Small parts	Retaining rings, thumb screws, rubber pads, bumpers, push knobs, grip, POM sleeves, shim pack	Local	Local	₹1,000–2,000

5. How to order

1. **Market machine:** buy the size you will sell first, with one pack of its pre-cut material sets (Phase 1).
2. **Light build:** needs a design and the forming checks first; then send drawings to a private CNC shop (aluminium parts, columns) and a die shop (die set).
3. **Heavy MagPress:** wait for the square-kit rework. Then send the drawing PDF and DXF zip with the material and heat-treatment column. Ask for a price per part and an inspection report on the H7 bores, the 210.00 hole pitch and the kit openings. Kit parts: rough machine, vacuum harden, then wire EDM and grind.
4. For any build, buy the springs, bushings, pins and fasteners yourself before the parts arrive, so the shop can test-fit them.
5. Move to Phase 2 consumables once sales are steady: measure a bought set with calipers, then cut your own to the same sizes.

Sources

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